

Prevocational Services Working Group Recap

Indiana
Missouri
New Jersey
New York
Ohio
Oklahoma
Texas
Utah

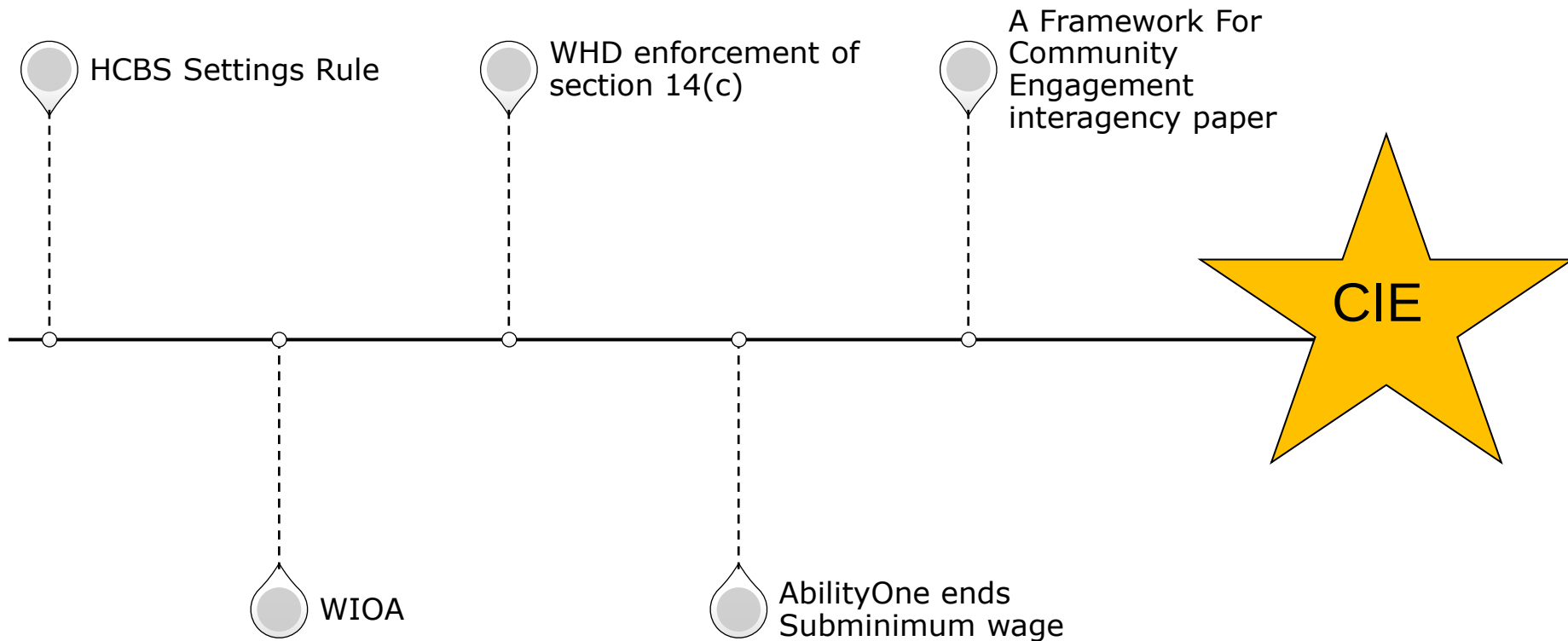
July-August 2023



The SELN is a joint program of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston and the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services.

www.selnhub.org

Current Context Setting



What are the desired outcomes of quality employment & day services? You said:

Competitive Integrated Employment

Business connection

Community engagement

Transferable skills

Informed Choice

Skill Development

Goal Oriented

Dignity of Risk

Dynamic

You said:

**What can only
be
accomplished
in
prevocational
services?**

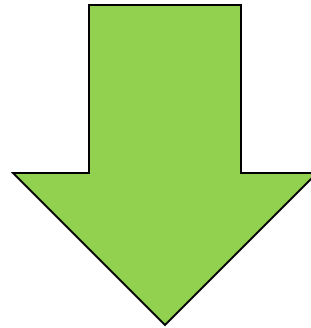
Time and space to
convince others

Address most significant
needs

Stability (for the person,
family and/or provider)

A controlled
environment

Poll: Could people ***still*** experience great employment success without access to prevocational services?



100%
answered
'Yes'

What would happen if CMS eliminated pre-vocational from approved services? You said:

People would go to other services (possibly non-work) (4)

Providers would be unhappy and/or close (3)

Providers would be motivated to provide more immediate support for getting a job

Don't think there would be a huge shift in employment outcomes

We would all figure out a solution (probably better)

We asked states to consider two pathways

Withdrawal

How will the system need to change if prevoc services are eliminated?

Reform

What updates or revisions would make prevoc services "better"?

Withdrawal

- Ramp up early intervention and capacity at schools
- Shift trajectory of youth
- Move prevoc activities back to school
- Infuse money into transportation
- Expand community integration services
- Change mindset of professionals (no more readiness model)
- Provide robust opportunities for organizational transformation
- Diversify funding models
- Focus on benefits planning
- Share success stories
- Have more inclusive trade school options and a vision around careers
- Peer to peer mentoring for: people, families, businesses and providers
- Major investment in provider capacity building to support CIE outcomes
- Raise expectations
- Create new services

Reform

- Multiple-level approval before referral
- Age adjusted time limits
- More defined outcomes
- Clearer monitoring
- % requirements for community settings
- Enter with a transition plan
- Milestones
 - Incentive payments for connection to employment
 - Provider mandated community mapping
- Curriculum:
 - Systematic instruction
- Benchmarks to identify skills early
- Communities of practice
- Time limitation
- Stronger language about what it should not be used for

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Questions not answered:

- How are we measuring ***provider*** performance in prevoc?
- How do we define readiness?
- What are the training and data reporting requirements for prevoc?

Which component of prevoc do you see as most necessary in meeting desired outcomes identified ?

Skill Building



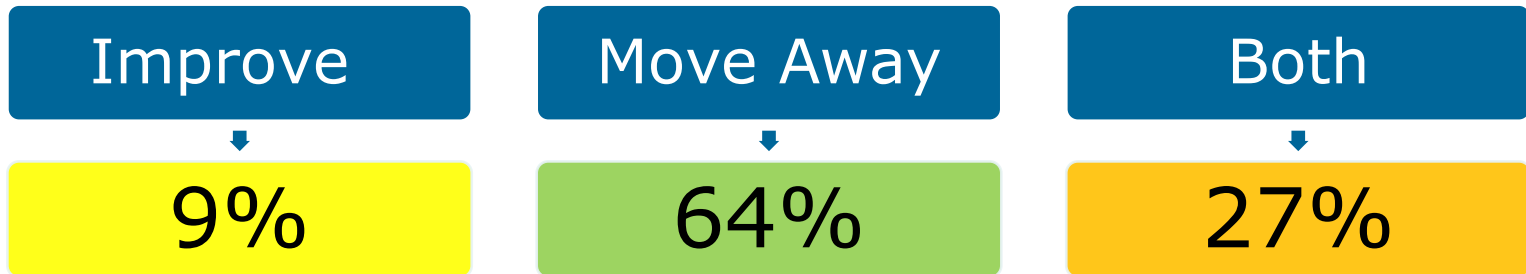
38%

Career Planning

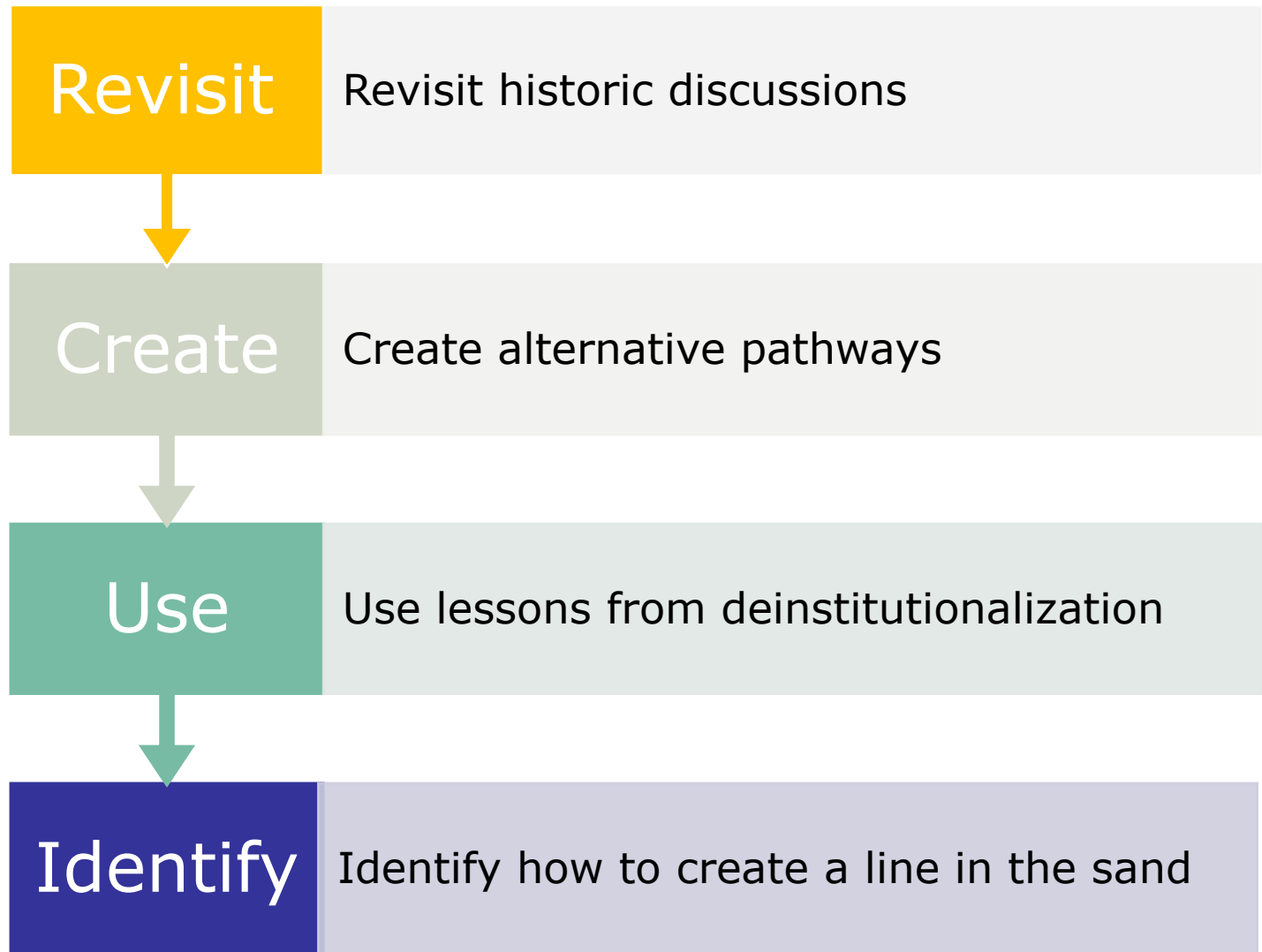


62%

If SELN were to advocate for federal resources related to prevoc, where should the focus be?



**What
should
happen
before
considering
removal of
prevoc?**



13

**Would the service system be
healthier if prevoc did not
exist?**

Considerations

Are CMS descriptions of prevoc consistent with desired outcomes?

[2011 CMS technical guide regarding employment and employment related services\(cms.gov\)](https://www.cms.gov/2011-CMS-technical-guide-regarding-employment-and-employment-related-services)

CMS technical guide

Intended to develop and teach general, non-job specific skills

What we know

Skills and behaviors don't generalize

People get ready by doing

People need customized job matches

Are CMS descriptions of prevoc consistent with desired outcomes?

[2011 CMS technical guide regarding employment and employment related services\(cms.gov\)](#)

CMS technical guide

Designed to create a path to integrated community employment at competitive wages

Intended to assist individual to enter the general workforce

Time limited

What we know

There is limited movement from prevoc services

Other interventions are more successful, and evidence based

Time limitations are unevenly applied, if at all

Are CMS descriptions of prevoc consistent with desired outcomes?

[2011 CMS technical guide regarding employment and employment related services\(cms.gov\)](#)

CMS technical guide

Not for the provision of vocational services in facility or sheltered settings

What we know

Vocational and sheltered work exists

Providers need intentional support to transform service models

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environment

***...or, are there different
pathways?***